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General Comment

It is easy to pretend, especially if one likes to listen to popular people who call themselves intelligent, that Large Language Models ("AI") are to the modern day what factory industrialization was two hundred years ago. And they do share a commonality; the complete deskilling, atomization, and immiseration of artisans can be easily likened to the possible fates of artists, authors, engineers, musicians, and critical-thinking-enjoyers at large. But the industrial revolution lead to wealth, products, economic possibility—for all its human and environmental cost, it *gave* us something concrete. The investors behind LLM startups promise to do the same, to broaden the scope of society beyond whatever could be previously imagined.

They are lying.

By their construction, LLMs can give us nothing humans already do—they merely plagiarize, remix, and hallucinate a possible data point between what it has already devoured. LLMs train on other LLMs, creating feedback loops of inaccuracies all citing each others' lies as proof. Primarily, "AI" has enriched a group of wealthy few who speculate on the future of our society. By smoothing over the promising and complicated technology of LLMs into a shiny project, these hucksters has created an underclass of impoverished moderators desperately steering the model away from regurgitating racist lies, environmental devastation while our planet tumbles toward irreversible climate damage, and a frustrated consumer adrift on a sea of shiny falsehoods made by no human hand which can ever be held to account. There is no soul, no promise to AGI—merely a sequence of snake oil billionaires so full of their own success they neglect the input of intelligent and measured critique. Use of LLMs has been demonstrated to erode the critical thinking of its users—there is no promise of a transformative future here. There is only billions of dollars to be lost on wisps of dreams.

This technology—and its many promises, amidst its woeful modern implementations—is best left regulated and studied carefully, its great power guarded behind human-first interface design, its many possibilities kept as tools first and economically-destructive-pseudo-human-replacements second.